



Home Services Mobile App Development

Proposal



Section A - RESPONSE SUMMARY

September 30, 2025

Kate Angina

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Cover Letter For Request For Proposal

Dear Duke Energy Selection Committee,

On behalf of Orases, I am pleased to submit our comprehensive proposal for the Development of a Home Services Mobile App. We are genuinely excited about the opportunity to partner with Duke Energy on this innovative project that will enhance the customer experience and streamline home services delivery.

Orases brings extensive expertise in mobile application development, with a proven track record of delivering robust, user-friendly solutions for enterprise clients. We understand the unique challenges and opportunities in the energy sector, and we are confident that our technical capabilities and customer-centric approach align perfectly with Duke Energy's vision for this mobile platform.

Our complete RFP response, including the detailed technical proposal, project timeline, budget breakdown, and all supporting documentation, has been uploaded to your Wood McKenzie portal for your review. We have carefully addressed each requirement outlined in your RFP and believe our solution will exceed your expectations.

We would welcome the opportunity to discuss our proposal in greater detail and answer any questions you may have. Thank you for considering Orases as your development partner for this exciting initiative.

Sincerely,

Tom Witt

Orases

Email: tom@orases.com

Phone: 703.585.7499

Section B – Scope of Work Requirements

Bidder shall review and respond to the requirements detailed in the Scope of Work in this document.

Orases has thoroughly reviewed Duke Energy Residential Solutions' scope of work and confirms our ability to deliver a comprehensive solution that exceeds the stated requirements. Our approach addresses not only the technical specifications outlined in the RFP but also the broader strategic objectives revealed during our discovery session.

Scope Confirmation & Enhanced Understanding

Core RFP Requirements - Confirmed

- ☒ Native Mobile App Development - iOS and Android native apps with full offline capabilities
- ☒ Mobile Web Version - Responsive web application with feature parity
- ☒ Enterprise System Integration - API development for Commerce, Dynamics, and contractor portal systems
- ☒ Content Management System - Custom Integrated CMS for DIY content, promotions, and product catalog
- ☒ Hosting Services - Cloud-based hosting with enterprise-grade security and scalability
- ☒ Ongoing Support & Maintenance - 24/7 support with dedicated development team
- ☒ Strategic Enhancement Opportunities Identified

During our discovery session, we identified several critical business needs that extend beyond the core RFP scope but are essential for achieving your strategic objectives:

Product Catalog Management System

Business Need: You currently lack a system to manage ad-hoc service pricing and offerings

Our Solution: Custom product management platform with dynamic pricing capabilities

Advanced Scheduling Engine

Business Need:

Current contractor scheduling is manual and inefficient

Our Solution:

AI-powered scheduling optimization with real-time availability management

Payment Processing Architecture

Business Need:

Separate payment flows for covered services, ad-hoc services, and non-native customers

Our Solution:

Unified payment platform with multiple processor support and billing integration

White-Label Platform Foundation

Business Need:

Future expansion to other utilities requires scalable architecture

Our Solution:

Multi-tenant platform design from Day 1 to support future white-labeling

Phase 1 Deliverables - Detailed Response

Foundation Features

Requirement	Our Approach	Added Value
HPP Scheduling	Real-time contractor matching with 2-way calendar sync	Automated scheduling reduces coordination calls by 80%
Home Inventory	Guided setup with barcode/photo scanning	AI-powered appliance recognition and warranty lookup
Customer Profile	Multi-property support with utility account linking	Seamless transition for customers moving between territories
DIY Content	CMS with video hosting and interactive guides	Analytics-driven content recommendations
Payment Integration	SpeedPay integration plus alternative processors	Supports expansion to non-native customers

Technical Architecture Response

Integration Strategy: We will develop robust APIs that not only connect to your existing Commerce and Dynamics systems but also prepare for future integrations with:

- Utility billing systems (Duke Energy, Piedmont)
- Third-party IoT platforms
- Energy efficiency program databases
- Contractor management systems

Data Management: Our solution includes a customer data platform that will serve as the central repository for home inventory, service history, and customer preferences while maintaining appropriate data segregation for regulatory compliance.

Security & Compliance: Enterprise-grade security implementation including role-based access control, data encryption, and audit logging to meet Duke Energy's cybersecurity requirements.

Beyond Phase 1 - Strategic Partnership Value

Immediate Quick Wins (Phase 1 Extensions)

- Contractor Mobile App: Streamline contractor workflow with dedicated mobile tools
- Analytics Dashboard: Real-time business intelligence for operations optimization
- Customer Communication Hub: Automated notifications and status updates

Business Model Enablement

Our solution directly enables your strategic business objectives:

- Non-Native Customer Acquisition: Payment processing independence from utility billing
- Service Portfolio Expansion: Product catalog management for ad-hoc services
- Market Differentiation: "Uber of home services" experience with transparent pricing
- Revenue Growth: Data-driven upselling and cross-selling capabilities

Success Metrics Alignment

Our solution directly supports your stated business objectives with measurable outcomes:

- Customer Satisfaction: Target NPS improvement from baseline to 70+
- Operational Efficiency: 40% reduction in service-related call center volume
- Revenue Growth: \$25M in new ad-hoc service revenue within 12 months
- Market Expansion: 250K non-native customer acquisition within 24 months

Conclusion

Orases not only meets every requirement outlined in your scope of work, our team brings strategic value that transforms this project from an app development initiative into a comprehensive business platform that will drive Duke Energy Residential Solutions' growth for years to come. Our 25 years of experience in custom software development, combined with our recent success in similar home services platforms, positions us as the ideal partner to execute this vision.

Section C – Experience

Provide a description of experience with similar work and results achieved. Include any experience you may have with Duke Energy.

Home Paramount Pest Control

The Challenge

Legacy Systems Hinder Pest Control Data Management

Home Paramount Pest Control relied on a legacy system that lacked full ownership and control over their data, hindering critical business operations. The existing solution, a shared off-the-shelf product, failed to meet the company's evolving needs and presented limitations in terms of customization and data accessibility. Furthermore, the organization's reliance on paper-based processes resulted in inefficiencies across various departments.

The primary challenges identified were recreating the system without direct access to the existing one, building a new system that provides full ownership and control over data, modernizing and streamlining previously paper-based, inefficient business processes, and implementing features such as automated scheduling, data validation, and integrated sales and contract management that the old system lacked. These issues caused Home Paramount Pest Control to seek a custom software solution that would address their specific needs and provide a modern, streamlined approach to their business operations.

The Solution

Modernized multi-component system architecture

The project involves building a new system for Home Paramount Pest Control to replace their existing off-the-shelf product. The new system consists of three main components: an ERP system that serves as the core of the solution, a customer portal, and a mobile app with offline capabilities for field technicians.

The customer portal provides a modern, clean user interface with basic security measures, allowing customers to log in, view invoices, and make payments. The mobile app is a progressive web app (PWA) that is used by field technicians to record their work on-site (what was sprayed/caught), rather than relying on paper-based processes.

The core of the solution is the **ERP system**, which handles all the day-to-day business operations, including scheduling, routing, invoicing, commissions, and reporting. This ERP system is integrated with the customer portal and mobile app, providing a comprehensive solution for Home Paramount's business needs.

One of the key features of the new system is the ability to handle multiple services and contracts within a single agreement, streamlining the sales process for the customer. Additionally, the system includes automated scheduling and routing algorithms to optimize the technicians' time and reduce the distance they need to travel. Ultimately, reducing the dependence on paper and digitizing the sale process.

Another important aspect of the solution is the focus on data validation and integrity, ensuring that the data entered into the system is complete and accurate, reducing the need for manual cleanup on the back end. Plus, their data is secure meaning only they can see it and have access.

Results

The implementation resulted in a secure client portal providing comprehensive service visibility, automated routing algorithms for optimized field operations, an offline-capable mobile app for efficient on-site reporting, and streamlined data processing systems. These enhancements significantly improved client engagement, maximized employee productivity in the field, and reduced manual data entry tasks for office staff, leading to overall operational efficiency gains.

Roy Jorgensen Associates

The Challenge

Refocusing JAMMS (Jorgensen Asset Maintenance Management System) to core business processes

Jorgensen had an old Borland C++ legacy system that was becoming dated, difficult to support, and had strayed from the organization's key management philosophies: planning, executing and controlling work activities. Jorgensen wanted to recapture these philosophies through the development and implementation of a new management tool — JAMMS 3.0 — in addition to having a modern cloud-based software product. The goal was to build JAMMS 3.0 in a modular way to allow for seamless integration with other core business processes, like human resources, inventory management and payroll processing integration.

Solution

Automating complex processes

The new JAMMS 3.0 powered by 24Watch® Business Suite enabled Jorgensen to rapidly understand and automate even the most complex processes. The open and configurable suite consists of solutions for work/service requests, customer service, work schedule and status, future work planning, inventory management, resource management, along with alerts to give the right information to the right people. Jorgensen has been successfully managing asset maintenance contracts for more than 50 years — JAMMS 3.0 takes those business philosophies and amplifies Jorgensen's ability to iterate and innovate critical process capabilities — without forcing Jorgensen to change its processes and protocols.

A fundamental tool within JAMMS 3.0 is the mobile Android application used by the crew in the field. The mobile app was created specifically for Jorgensen field staff to focus on critical field work. The app is designed to help the team document their work while executing work orders, as well as view their scheduled tasks, apply time to daily work reports and activities, record accomplishments and ensure quality control on work orders. The app works offline and allows the crews to add data from anywhere regardless of cell or internet availability. Once the device is back online, the data entered will sync to the JAMMS system and be available in the admin area.

Results

New Features for JAMMS 3.0

- Streamlined data, easier to use, faster, compatible with third-party systems
- Data integrity and centralized database — no more duplicate records
- Faster and simplified workflows for creating and executing work
- Proactive work planning and scheduling
- Faster and more accurate reporting
- Ability to document and execute work offline via mobile app
- Fully compliant with any required standards for privacy and security
- Scalable and flexible enough to efficiently adapt for rapid business growth

National Football League (NFL) Foundation

The Challenge

Before Orases, the entire NFL Foundation grant program was paper-based. That meant that every application the office received from throughout the United States was hand-written and needed to be reviewed and filed by an employee. This process was extremely inefficient, and with a program of this magnitude, efficiency is important. The NFL Foundation needed a more streamlined process to manage the grant applications, from the time the information is sent out, to the time the money is awarded.

Solution

Out with the old, in with the new

Orases was able to create a Grant Application Management System (GAMS) for the Foundation. GAMS allows NFL staff to manage the application process from start to finish, communicate with and assist applicants throughout the process, review and approve applications, submit legal documentation, and cooperate with the NFL's finance program to automatically process checks to send to the grant awardees.

The grant management system allows NFL employees to give varying levels of permissions to different users, depending on their need and clearances, to protect the financial information of the NFL and the applicants.

New Features

User-friendly admin experience — Manage applicants simply with grant management system tracking software and collaboration tools, automated emails, and visual cues that help streamline actions.

Review grants with ease — Deploy a custom, branded portal and use the grant management system's powerful assignment tool to allocate applications. Allow for multiple rounds or levels of review.

Report builder — Allow users to build their own data reports, using features custom built in the grant management system, by choosing their own fields for individual reports.

Results

Improved access and efficiency

Since the launch of GAMS, the NFL has streamlined their grant operations and was able to reallocate 75% of their resources that previously went toward the grant program. The grant management system gives access to improved grant reporting, which tracks the awarded money down to the ZIP code location, allowing them to better serve all communities across the country.

Orases has worked with the NFL for over a decade to continue building on the original grant management platform, and they now have a system that automates the entire process from start to finish. The program has proven successful for the NFL, which was noted when the commissioner of the NFL gave the site the top three most innovative solutions in the NFL award upon launch.

MED-EL

The Challenge

MED-EL's objective was to make it easier for providers and patients to work with them while also enabling our internal teams to collaborate more effectively across the organization. They recognized they needed to modernize their manual processes to align with market standards and to offer a seamless experience for healthcare professionals.

They decided on a modern digital portal that would serve as a central hub for all their partners, providing them with key functionality, including access to patient data and device information. The long-term vision is to eventually have a patient and admin portal to provide even greater functionality. This is an ongoing project.

The Solution

The scope of work included the design and development of a custom web-based portal. This portal serves as a central hub, providing a single, integrated location for professionals to log in and manage their patients, view device information, track warranties, and handle service requests. A key technical deliverable was integrating three separate APIs (Microsoft CRM, Microsoft Navision, and Brightree) to pull together previously independent data streams into one seamless platform. Ultimately, the project's goal was to make their services and communication more automatic and hands-off, while also allowing their headquarters in Austria to have access and enabling professionals to be redirected to the US version.

Next Day Dumpster (NDD)

The Challenge

Off-the-shelf software limitations causing inefficiencies & communication issues

Next Day Dumpster's order intake process relied on an administrator who would take all of their orders on paper and then manually enter each order into their system each day. In addition, they were using multiple systems for pricing & quoting (MS Access), order tracking and delivery mapping (TRUX) & order processing (Third-Party Developer) which were not able to communicate with one another.

These off-the-shelf software solutions functioned in silos and created chokeholds on critical information. They could not be modified to fit their needs, causing inefficiencies and the inability for NDD to scale.

Their 3 Main Challenges Included:

1. Working on multiple systems which were unable to communicate with one another
2. Received orders on paper and manually entered orders into their system
3. Could not modify their off-the-shelf software to meet their needs and requirements

The Solution

Developed a single CRM solution which handled the entire ordering process

Orases was able to develop a custom CRM (customer relationship management) software solution which covered the MVP functionality of their existing pricing & quoting system (MS Access) and order tracking/delivery mapping system (TRUX).

This new system gave Next Day Dumpsters an administrative area which allowed them to manage pricing terms as they related to the clients location (as specific as their zip

code), type of service, activity, weight allowance, rental period, type of dumpster, taxes and extra charge items.

Orases' custom software development team developed a real-time API/Webhook connection with routing/dispatch software to give the CRM solution the ability to communicate back and forth about work orders.

These additional features and functionalities set up a basic structure for the possibility of future SaaS endeavors to resale their product.

Results

Increased efficiency & communication

The unique features and functionality of the custom CRM system streamlines the quoting and ordering intake process, which eliminates the need to manually enter orders taken on paper.

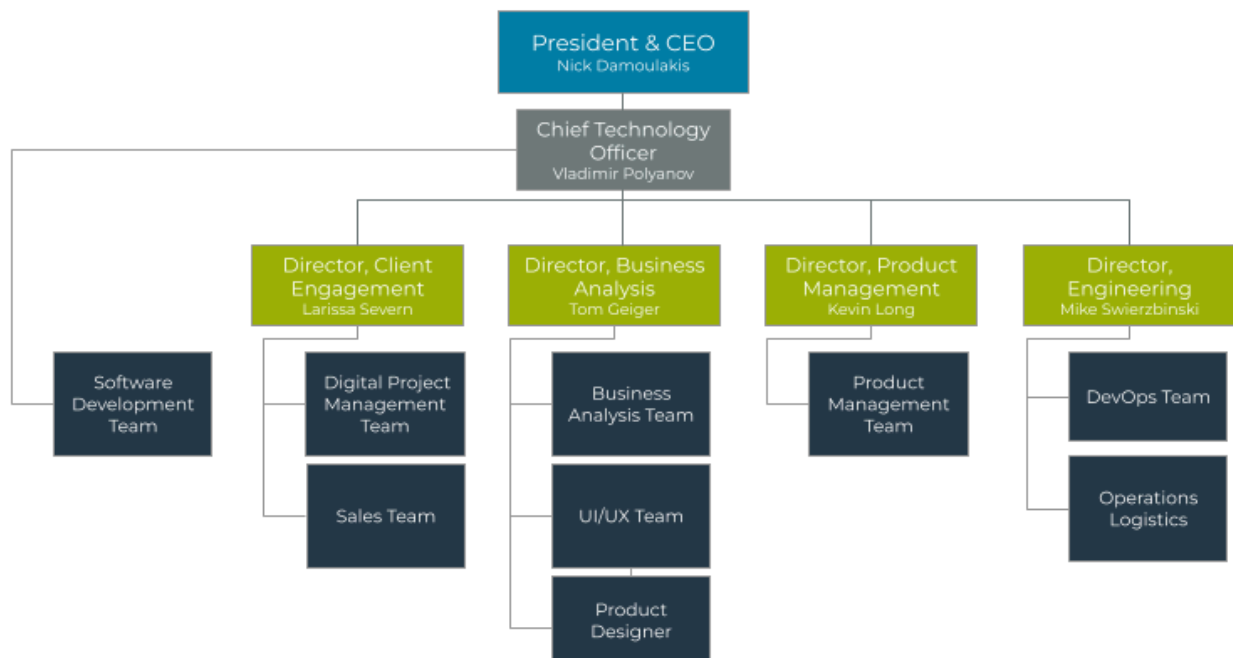
This additional functionality gives NDD the ability to manage services and work orders throughout the entire lifecycle of the order, therefore increasing efficiency and communication throughout their organization.

Section D – Management/Organization Structure

If awarded the contract for the services described herein, show how you would organize the management team and other personnel including roles, responsibilities, locations and key points of contact. Include an organizational chart and staffing plan to support Duke Energy. Include expectations for Duke Energy roles/responsibilities in your response to this RFP. Note any subcontracting that would be utilized and your relationship with any such vendors (tasks, vendor, duration, extent, work history, etc.)

All Orases employees are US-Based. We do not outsource any aspect of our development. Below is an organizational chart representing the team that will be in charge of the Home Services application.

Home Services Mobile App Team



The following three tables outline the roles and responsibilities for this opportunity. The first table reflects the management roles that will have visibility into the project and the teams they lead. The second table will be the project team and the third table will reflect the support team. These members will flex in and out of the project as needed.

Management Roles and Responsibilities

Team Member	Responsibilities
Chief Technology Officer, Vlad Polyanov	Leads and manages our Development Team and Directors
Director of Engineering, Mike Swierzbinski	Leads the DevOps and Operations Logistics Team
Director of Business Analysis, Tom Geiger	Leads the Business Analysis, UI/UX, & Product Designer Teams
Director of Product Management, Kevin Long	Leads the Product Management Team
Director of Client Engagement, Larissa Severn	- Leads our Digital Project Management and Sales Teams - Will provide visibility to the broader stakeholders through scheduled project scorecard and sponsor meetings

Core Team Member Roles and Responsibilities

Team Member	Responsibilities
Product Manager	• Technical leadership and product strategy • Provide guidance on project approaches, including advising on technical and business risks • Integrate business strategy and needs into the software delivery process
Digital Project Manager	• Plan and lead project from contract through completion, ensuring on time and on budget delivery • Lead team to meet project measures of success and KPIs • Proactively communicate project status to internal and external stakeholders, including risk management • Day-to-day POC for client
Product Designer	• Ensure best performance and user experience of the application • Focuses on designing intuitive and seamless interactions between users and the interface • Work closely with various stakeholders to implement the product design
Lead Business Analyst	• Requirements gathering & analysis, project plan/wireframing • Design, development & QA coordination • Deployment and product documentation
Lead Developer	• Defining architecture, capturing non functional (architectural) requirements, preparing estimates and defining technical solutions • Perform design to deployment related activities, provide guidance, perform reviews, prevent and resolve technical issues • Manage technical landscape for changing business requirements and priorities • Verify and deploy programs and systems

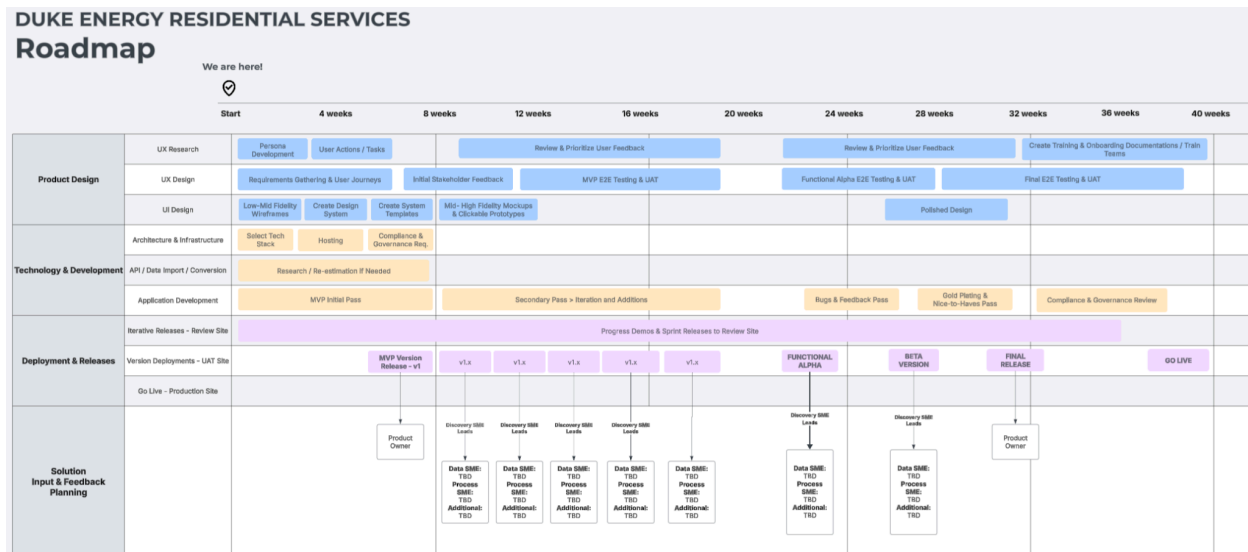
Support Team Member Roles and Responsibilities

Team Member	Responsibilities
Support Developers	• Develop new user facing features • Produce clean, efficient code based on specifications for each feature • Troubleshoot, debug and upgrade code base • Integrate software components and third party programs
Support Business Analysts/UI/UX	• Requirements gathering & analysis • Project plan/wireframing • Design, development & QA coordination • Deployment and product documentation
DevOps Specialists / SMEs	• Architecting, provisioning, and managing infrastructure and deployment processes • Monitoring application and infrastructure performance, security, events, etc. And optimizing them to ensure maximum performance and availability • Integrating security and compliance controls into the DevOps process. Ensuring security at all stages - development, testing, deployment, and infrastructure management

Section E – Implementation and Duke Energy Support Plan

Provide the implementation plan and timeline you anticipate following in order to achieve results. Show any milestones or key deliverables. Describe recommended implementation approach (agile, waterfall, hybrid, etc.) in your response to this RFP. Provide a timeline for launch to be performed in conjunction with Duke Energy.

Please see attached file ( Duke Timeline.png) to view the graphic below



Detailed Project Approach, Timeline, and Implementation Strategy

1. Recommended Implementation Strategy

Business-First Agile Approach

Our strategy centers on delivering immediate business value while building a scalable foundation for Duke Energy Residential Solutions' long-term growth. We propose a

hybrid agile methodology that combines rapid iteration with enterprise-grade architecture planning.

Approach & Implementation

Orases will utilize a hybrid agile methodology to ensure that the best possible product features are built that provide Duke Energy with exactly what they need to be successful by prioritizing only the development of necessary functionality. This approach also optimizes the time that will be needed for ongoing discovery, development, design, and quality assurance within each project sprint.

As the product owner and the client, Duke Energy has the responsibility to review all features being developed. This will be an ongoing process throughout the project development.

Core Strategic Pillars:

- Customer-Centric Development: Start with existing Duke customers' most critical pain points
- Parallel Workstream Execution: Simultaneous development of mobile app, APIs, and backend systems
- Incremental Value Delivery: Bi-weekly demos with usable features every sprint
- Risk-Mitigated Rollout: Phased deployment starting with pilot contractor network

2. Critical Assumptions Affecting Project Approach

Technical Assumptions

- Duke Energy will provide API documentation and sandbox access within 2 weeks of project kickoff

- Existing Commerce/Dynamics systems can support API load without performance degradation
- Contractor portal systems have available integration endpoints or can be modified
- SpeedPay integration specifications are available and current

Business Assumptions

- Duke SMEs will be available 10-15 hours per week for requirements validation and testing
- Contractor network will participate in pilot program (current assumption: 25 contractors across 3 markets)
- Product catalog for ad-hoc services will be defined by Duke during Weeks 8-12
- Customer communications (legal/privacy notices) will be approved by Duke legal team

Resource Assumptions

- Duke IT will provide integration support and security reviews within agreed timeframes
- Customer research access will be granted for user testing phases
- Content for DIY library will be provided or jointly developed during design phase

3. Functional and Technical Risks

HIGH RISK - Requires Immediate Attention

- Legacy System Integration Complexity: Commerce/Dynamics systems may have undocumented limitations
 - Mitigation: Early integration prototyping, dedicated integration specialist, fallback API gateway
- Contractor Network Adoption: Slow contractor onboarding could limit service availability
 - Mitigation: Dedicated contractor success manager, phased rollout, incentive program
- Payment Processing Compliance: Multiple payment flows (utility billing, credit cards, contractor collection)
 - Mitigation: Early legal/compliance review, PCI-DSS certification planning, payment flow prototyping

MEDIUM RISK - Monitor Closely

- Data Privacy Regulations: Home inventory data sensitivity across multiple states
 - Mitigation: Privacy-by-design architecture, legal review checkpoints, data minimization strategies
- Mobile App Store Approval: Complex payment flows may trigger additional app store scrutiny
 - Mitigation: Early app store consultation, alternative payment flow designs, web app fallback
- Scalability Planning: Rapid user growth could overwhelm initial architecture
 - Mitigation: Cloud-native design, auto-scaling infrastructure, performance testing throughout development

LOW RISK - Standard Mitigation

- Third-party API Dependencies: SpeedPay or other vendor API changes
- Resource Availability: Key Duke Energy team member availability during critical phases
- Technology Evolution: Mobile OS updates during development cycle

4. Work Outside Project Scope

Explicitly Excluded

- Utility Billing System Integration: Direct integration with regulated utility billing systems
- Contractor Business System Modifications: Changes to individual contractor management software
- Marketing Campaign Development: Customer acquisition campaigns and promotional materials
- Legal Documentation: Terms of service, privacy policies, regulatory compliance documentation
- Content Creation: Photography, video production for DIY library (consultation provided)

Future Phase Considerations

- IoT Device Integration: Smart home device connectivity (Phase 2/3)
- AI/ML Features: Predictive maintenance algorithms (Phase 2)
- White-label Platform: Multi-tenant architecture activation (Phase 3)
- Advanced Analytics: Business intelligence dashboards (Phase 1.5)

5. Transition from RFP to Project Launch

Contract Negotiation Phase (2-3 weeks)

- Week 1: Technical deep-dive sessions with Duke IT and business teams
- Week 2: Integration testing with Duke systems, security review initiation
- Week 3: Final scope refinement, resource allocation confirmation, contract execution

Project Initiation (Week 1 post-contract)

- Day 1-2: Team onboarding, security clearances, system access requests
- Day 3-5: Discovery workshop completion, requirements finalization
- Week 1 End: Project charter approval, communication protocols established

Early Success Milestones

- Week 2: First API connection established
- Week 4: Interactive prototype demonstration
- Week 8: MVP feature set validation with pilot users

6. Detailed Project Plan by Phase

PLANNING PHASE (Weeks 1-4)

Key Activities:

- Stakeholder interviews and requirements validation

- Technical architecture design and approval
- User research and persona validation
- Project infrastructure setup

Deliverables:

- Finalized requirements document
- Technical architecture specification
- User experience strategy
- Project communication plan

ANALYSIS & HIGH-LEVEL DESIGN (Weeks 4-12)

Key Activities:

- API specification development
- Database schema design
- User interface wireframing
- Integration mapping

Deliverables:

- API documentation and specifications
- Database design document
- UX wireframes and user journeys
- Integration architecture document

DETAILED DESIGN (Weeks 8-16)

Key Activities:

- High-fidelity UI mockups
- Detailed technical specifications
- Security and compliance framework
- Testing strategy development

Deliverables:

- Complete UI/UX design system
- Technical specification documents
- Security implementation plan
- Comprehensive test plan

BUILD PHASE (Weeks 12-32)

Key Activities:

- Agile development sprints (2-week iterations)
- Continuous integration/continuous deployment setup
- Regular stakeholder demonstrations
- Ongoing code review and quality assurance

Deliverables:

- MVP release (Week 20)
- Functional Alpha (Week 24)

- Beta version (Week 28)
- Release candidate (Week 32)

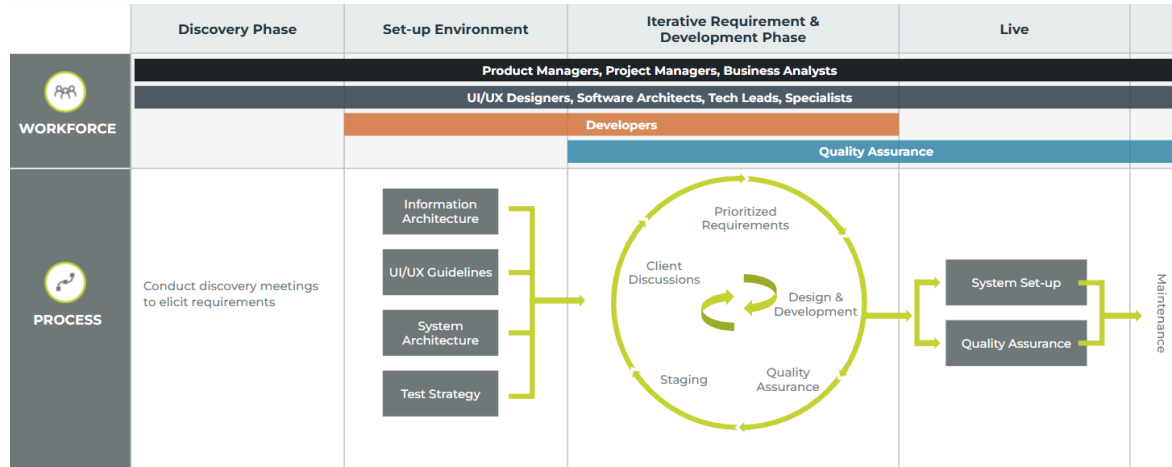
Sprint Lifecycle

The lifecycle of each sprint is described below.

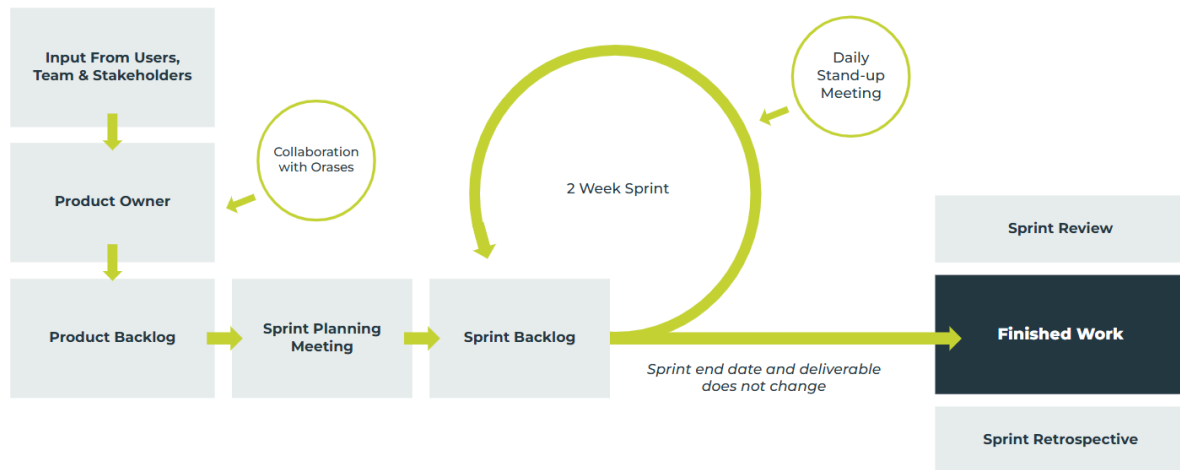
- The development will be completed iteratively and will generally be broken down into sprints lasting approximately 2 weeks.
 - Prior to starting a sprint:
 - The project team will create the user stories.
 - The project team will determine the user stories that will be included within the sprint.
 - Orases developers will review all artifacts associated with the user stories to ensure they have what they deem necessary to complete the development portion of the sprint.
 - Artifacts such as wireframes, design mockups, workflows, spreadsheets with formulas, data import files, etc.
 - Within the sprint:
 - Orases will develop and test what is required to satisfy the user stories. *See the Definition of "Done" for a User Story below.*
 - The project team will meet as needed to discuss any necessary changes if they are discovered.
 - Orases will frequently report on all progress made within the sprint to the entire project team.
 - All feedback from the project team about a completed sprint will be provided to Orases in a timely manner.
 - The project team will refine the backlog to prepare for the next sprint.
 - Finishing a Sprint:
 - The project team will have a Sprint Review meeting showing all completed user stories on a beta site for Duke Energy to provide feedback and visibility into work and then take it for additional testing and final approval.

- The project team will have a Sprint Planning meeting to prepare for the next sprint that involves prioritizing user stories and reviewing the entire project backlog.

Iterative Development Approach



Sprint Process



TEST PHASE (Weeks 24-36)

Key Activities:

- Comprehensive testing execution
- User acceptance testing coordination
- Performance and security testing
- Bug resolution and optimization

Deliverables:

- Test execution reports
- Performance benchmarking results
- Security audit completion
- Go-live readiness assessment

Definition of “Done” for a User Story

Below are the conditions that must be met before a user story can be considered completed or “done”.

1. The code is committed to the Orases review server for testing.
2. Orases performs Quality Assurance Testing (QAT) and confirms completed conditions of satisfaction.
3. The user story, if applicable, has been demoed and released to client for review.

DEPLOYMENT (Weeks 36-40)**Key Activities:**

- Production environment setup
- Phased rollout execution

- Go-live support
- Initial user onboarding

Deliverables:

- Live production system
- User training materials
- Operational procedures
- Performance monitoring setup

WARRANTY PERIOD (Weeks 40-44)

Key Activities:

- Post-launch monitoring and support
- Issue resolution and optimization
- Performance tuning
- Knowledge transfer

Deliverables:

- Stability reports
- Performance optimization recommendations
- Complete documentation handover
- Transition to ongoing support

7. Project Timeline Summary

Phase	Duration	Start	Finish	Key Milestone
Planning & Analysis	12 weeks	Week 1	Week 12	Requirements Finalization
Design & Architecture	8 weeks	Week 8	Week 16	Design Approval
Development MVP	8 weeks	Week 12	Week 20	MVP Release
Alpha Development	4 weeks	Week 20	Week 24	Alpha Testing
Beta Development	4 weeks	Week 24	Week 28	Beta Release
Final Development	4 weeks	Week 28	Week 32	Release Candidate
Testing & QA	4 weeks	Week 32	Week 36	Go-Live Approval
Deployment	4 weeks	Week 36	Week 40	Production Launch
Warranty Support	4 weeks	Week 40	Week 44	Transition Complete

Total Project Duration: 44 weeks (11 months)

Target Go-Live: Q2 2026 (aligns with Duke's Q2-Q3 2026 target) **

(** dependant on project start date)

8. Resource Requirements and Skill Sets

Orases Team Structure (Vendor-Provided)

Core Team -

- Technical Product Manager: 10+ years enterprise integration experience
- Project Manager: PMP certified, enterprise software experience
- (2) Senior Full-Stack Developers: Enterprise app experience
- (1) Full-Stack Developer: React/Node.js, API development, database design

- Senior Business Analyst: Requirements gathering, process optimization

Specialized Support (Part-time/Phase-specific) -

- Product Designer: Mobile-first design, enterprise user experience
- DevOps Engineer: Cloud infrastructure, CI/CD, security implementation
- QA Specialist: Test automation, performance testing

Peak Resource Period: Weeks 16-32 (Development phase)

Duke Energy Required Resources

Business Team -

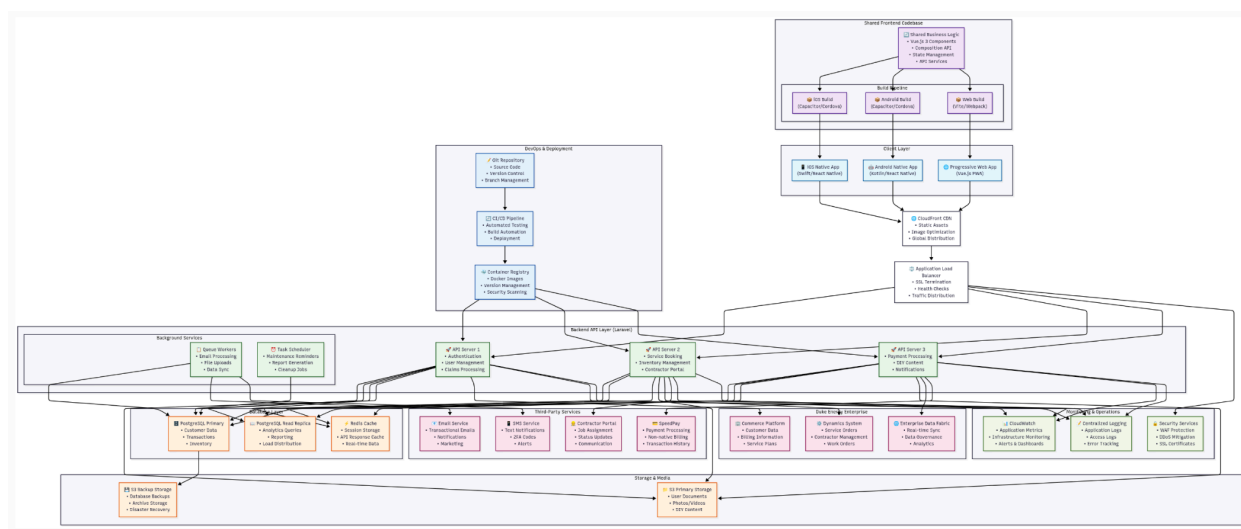
- Product Owner: Requirements validation, business decision authority
- Business Analyst: Process documentation, contractor coordination
- Marketing Representative: Brand guidelines, content approval
- Process SMEs: As needed

Technical Team (if available) -

- IT Architect: Integration planning, security review
- Database Administrator: Data migration support, performance optimization
- Security Specialist: Compliance validation, security testing

Address the Detailed Technical Requirements Questionnaire document attached to this RFP. Discuss any limitations and emphasize any core competencies. Discuss how your firm plans to meet the requirements listed as well as potential to deliver against long term needs. Provide responses to the Detailed Requirements and Experience document in an Excel formatted document.

📄 DukeEnergy_TechnicalDiagram.png)



Enterprise Mobile Development

- 25+ years of custom software development experience
- Native iOS/Android development with offline capabilities
- Progressive Web App (PWA) development for universal access
- Laravel/Vue.js stack expertise with proven enterprise scalability

Enterprise Integration Expertise

- RESTful API development and consumption
- Real-time data synchronization
- Enterprise security implementation (OAuth 2.0, MFA, role-based access)
- Cloud infrastructure management (AWS certified team)

Proven Track Record in Similar Domains

- Home services platforms (Home Paramount - pest control management)
- Field service management (Roy Jorgenson - JAMMS 3.0)
- Large-scale applications (NFL Foundation grant management)
- Customer portal development (Next Day Dumpsters CRM)

Meeting Duke Energy's Technical Requirements

Native Mobile Apps (iOS/Android)

- Capability: Full native development with offline functionality
- Approach: React Native or nativeScript based on performance requirements
- Offline Support: Local data caching, sync when connectivity restored
- Performance: Optimized for 200K-2M user scale

Mobile Web Version

- Capability: Responsive Progressive Web App (PWA)
- Approach: 90% codebase shared with Native Mobile app - ensures cost and time efficient development and support optimization
- Feature Parity: Complete functionality matching native apps
- Cross-Platform: Works across all devices and browsers
- Performance: Lazy loading, efficient caching strategies

Backend Infrastructure Requirements

API Development

- Laravel Framework: Robust API development with built-in security
- RESTful Architecture: Scalable, maintainable API design
- Real-time Capabilities: WebSocket integration for live updates
- Documentation: Comprehensive API documentation and testing

Database Management

- Primary: PostgreSQL or MySQL for transactional data
- Caching: Redis for high-performance data access
- Backup: Automated backup and disaster recovery
- Scaling: Read replicas and horizontal scaling support

Enterprise System Integration

Duke Energy Systems Integration

- Commerce Platform: API integration for customer data and billing
- Dynamics Integration: Service order management and contractor coordination
- Data Fabric: Seamless data flow with enterprise architecture
- Authentication: SSO integration with Duke Energy identity systems

Third-Party Integrations

- SpeedPay: Payment processing for non-native customers
- Contractor Portals: Real-time job assignment and status updates
- Content APIs: Integration with manufacturer databases and warranty systems

Security & Compliance

Enterprise Security Standards

- Data Encryption: End-to-end encryption for sensitive data
- Access Control: Role-based permissions and multi-factor authentication
- Audit Logging: Comprehensive activity tracking and reporting
- Compliance: GDPR, CCPA, and state-specific privacy regulations

Infrastructure Security

- AWS Security: VPC, WAF, and security groups configuration
- Certificate Management: SSL/TLS encryption for all communications
- Penetration Testing: Regular security assessments and remediation
- Monitoring: Real-time security threat detection and response

Addressing Potential Limitations

Acknowledged Limitations

Enterprise AI Integration

- Current State: Basic AI suggestions included in MVP
- Limitation: Advanced AI features may require Duke Energy corporate approval
- Mitigation: Architecture designed for future AI enhancement, clear approval pathway established

Legacy System Complexity

- Challenge: Unknown complexity of existing Duke Energy systems
- Mitigation: Comprehensive discovery phase, flexible integration architecture
- Approach: Incremental integration with fallback strategies

Multi-State Regulatory Variations

- Complexity: Different regulations across Duke Energy territories
- Solution: Configurable compliance framework, state-specific rule engines
- Support: Legal and compliance consulting available

Risk Mitigation Strategies

Technical Risks

- Performance Scaling: Load testing at each milestone, auto-scaling infrastructure
- Integration Failures: Comprehensive testing environments, API versioning
- Data Migration: Staged migration approach, extensive backup procedures

Project Risks

- Scope Changes: Hybrid agile methodology with change management process
- Timeline Pressure: AI-assisted development for 31% efficiency gain
- Resource Availability: Dedicated team commitment with backup resources

Long-Term Delivery Potential

Phase 2+ Strategic Capabilities

White-Label Platform Development

- Multi-Tenancy: Architecture designed from Day 1 for multiple utility partners
- Customization: Configurable branding, features, and business rules
- Scalability: Support for multiple utility territories and regulatory environments

Advanced Analytics & AI

- Predictive Maintenance: Machine learning for equipment failure prediction
- Customer Insights: Advanced analytics for service optimization
- Automated Scheduling: AI-powered contractor matching and route optimization

IoT Integration Readiness

- Smart Home Connectivity: Framework for device integration
- Real-time Monitoring: Sensor data processing and alert systems
- Automated Service Triggers: Proactive maintenance scheduling

Technology Evolution Support

Emerging Technologies

- AR/VR Integration: Augmented reality for remote diagnostics
- Voice Interfaces: Integration with smart speakers and voice assistants
- Blockchain: Secure contractor credentialing and service verification

Platform Modernization

- Microservices Architecture: Gradual evolution to microservices
- Cloud-Native: Full utilization of cloud-native technologies
- API-First Design: Complete API ecosystem for third-party integration

Implementation Approach

Development Methodology

Hybrid Agile Development Process

- 2-Week Sprints: Rapid iteration with continuous feedback
- Stakeholder Involvement: Regular reviews and approval cycles
- Quality Assurance: Built-in testing and code review processes
- Documentation: Comprehensive technical and user documentation

AI-Assisted Development

- Claude Code Integration: 31% efficiency improvement
- Code Quality: Enhanced consistency and reduced technical debt
- Accelerated Timeline: 6-month delivery vs traditional 8.5-month approach
- Cost Optimization: Significant savings passed to Duke Energy

Quality Assurance Framework

Testing Strategy

- Unit Testing: Comprehensive test coverage for all components
- Integration Testing: End-to-end system testing
- Performance Testing: Load testing for projected user volumes
- Security Testing: Penetration testing and vulnerability assessment

Deployment Strategy

- Staged Deployment: Development → Staging → Production
- Blue-Green Deployment: Zero-downtime production releases
- Monitoring: Real-time application and infrastructure monitoring
- Rollback Capability: Immediate rollback procedures if issues arise

Conclusion

Orases brings a unique combination of technical expertise, proven experience in similar domains, and innovative AI-assisted development approaches to deliver the Duke Energy Home Services Mobile App. Our comprehensive technical capabilities, risk mitigation strategies, and long-term vision align perfectly with Duke Energy's immediate needs and strategic objectives.

Key Differentiators:

- 31% cost and time savings through AI-assisted development
- Proven experience in home services and enterprise applications
- Scalable architecture supporting 200K to 2M+ user growth
- White-label platform foundation for future expansion
- Comprehensive security and compliance framework

We are confident in our ability to deliver a world-class mobile platform that will transform Duke Energy's home services delivery and provide a foundation for long-term growth and innovation.

Note: Detailed technical specifications and capability matrix will be provided in the accompanying Excel document as requested, containing point-by-point responses to all technical requirements with capability ratings, implementation approaches, and timeline estimates.

Section G – Fee Structure

Please complete the Pricing Matrix template provided. Please ensure pricing is clearly broken down for Technology Solution, Implementation Services, and any Ongoing Support. Please provide any further explanation for the fees you have outlined in your pricing proposal.

Note: Please do not include any pricing information in any other section of your Proposal.

Pricing Matrix has been uploaded to the portal.

Section H – Appendix (Optional)

This section is optional. Include any exhibits which may help to enhance your proposal. Reference each appendix here and label it clearly.

User Personas

At Orases, we leverage both User-Centered Design and Human-Centered Design processes in order to make sure that the solutions we design serve the business goals of our partners while delighting users, end-customers, and other individuals whose experience is affected by the solution.



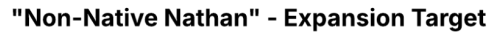
"Established Eleanor" - Existing Duke Customer

- **Demographics:** 58, homeowner for 15+ years, Duke customer, moderate tech comfort
- **Current Situation:** Has water heater protection plan, calls for service 2-3x/year
- **Pain Points:** Frustrated with phone-only service, no visibility into when contractor arrives, doesn't know contractor qualifications
- **Goals:** Self-service convenience, contractor transparency, service status tracking
- **Success Metrics:** Reduces service request time from 15 minutes to 3 minutes, 90% satisfaction with contractor communication



"Expanding Emma" - New Duke Customer

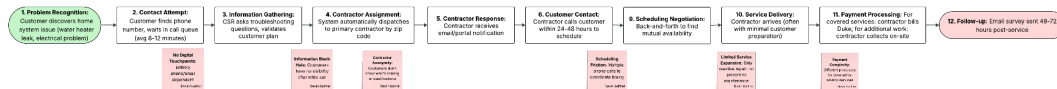
- **Demographics:** 34, first-time homeowner, Duke customer for 6 months, high tech adoption
- **Current Situation:** Recently purchased home, overwhelmed by maintenance needs, no existing protection plans
- **Pain Points:** Doesn't know what home systems need maintenance, unsure of reliable contractors, worried about cost surprises
- **Goals:** Proactive home management, trusted service providers, predictable pricing
- **Success Metrics:** Adds 5+ inventory items within first month, books first ad-hoc service, enrolls in 2+ protection plans



- **Demographics:** 41, homeowner, not a Duke utility customer, lives in Duke contractor service area
- **Current Situation:** Uses Angie's List/TaskRabbit for home services, frustrated with inconsistent quality
- **Pain Points:** Price shopping every service request, unreliable contractor vetting, no service history tracking
- **Goals:** One trusted home services platform, transparent pricing, service continuity
- **Success Metrics:** Completes first service booking within 2 weeks, refers 2+ neighbors, upgrades to protection plan

These three (3) personas are based on what we learned in our 90 minute discovery session together.

It's our goal to become experts in both your current process and your vision for the future. Based on our 90 minutes together so far, we've mapped our understanding of the current customer journey and highlighted pain points.



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Goals & Success Measures

Successful projects rely on agreed-upon quantitative metrics. These metrics ensure team alignment, define success, and guide decision-making. Based on our 90 minutes together, we've identified the following goals and potential success metrics:

GOALS AND SUCCESS MEASURES

Primary Business Goals	Customer Experience Goals	Operational Efficiency Goals	Innovation Goals
Customer Expansion: • Target: Grow customer base from 1.5M to 2M by end of Year 2 • Measure: Monthly active app users, new customer registrations	Self-Service Adoption: • Target: 60% of service requests initiated through app by end of Year 1 • Measure: App service requests vs. call center volume	Call Center Reduction: • Target: Reduce service-related calls by 40% in Year 1 • Measure: Call volume analytics, reason code tracking	Platform Scalability: • Target: White-label ready platform by Year 2 • Measure: Multi-tenant capability, API standardization
Revenue Growth: • Target: Generate \$25M in new ad-hoc service revenue in Year 1 • Measure: Non-contract service bookings, average revenue per user	Customer Satisfaction: • Target: Increase NPS from current baseline to 70+ • Measure: In-app ratings, post-service surveys, retention rates	Contractor Utilization: • Target: Increase contractor utilization by 25% • Measure: Jobs per contractor, geographic distribution	Smart Home Integration: • Target: Connect with 5+ major IoT platforms by Year 3 • Measure: Integration partnerships, automated service triggers
Market Position: • Target: Become #1 home services app in Duke service territory • Measure: App store rankings, competitor analysis, market share	Engagement: • Target: Average 3.5 app sessions per month per active user • Measure: App analytics, feature usage tracking	Data Collection: • Target: 80% of active users complete home inventory setup • Measure: Profile completion rates, inventory item count	

Pain Points

Addressing current process pain points for internal and external stakeholders is crucial for a smooth transition and successful solution adoption. Our 90-minute discussion identified key pain points we will address throughout our partnership:

COMPREHENSIVE PAIN POINTS LIST

Customer Experience Pain Points

Zero self-service options for service requests Devin Galtner	No real-time status updates on service requests Devin Galtner	Cannot see contractor credentials or ratings before service Devin Galtner
No centralized home inventory or maintenance history Devin Galtner	Limited to reactive repairs vs. proactive maintenance Devin Galtner	Billing constraints prevent non-Duke customers from enrolling Devin Galtner
No integration between home systems and service recommendations Devin Galtner		

Business Operations Pain Points

High call center volume for routine service requests Devin Galtner	No digital customer acquisition channel Devin Galtner	Limited market expansion due to billing dependencies Devin Galtner
Minimal customer engagement between service events Devin Galtner	No data collection on home inventory for upselling Devin Galtner	Cannot offer ad-hoc services due to product/pricing limitations Devin Galtner
Contractor utilization not optimized across service territory Devin Galtner		

Contractor Network Pain Points

Manual scheduling process increases administrative overhead Devin Galtner	Limited customer information for service preparation Devin Galtner	No standardized communication channels with customers Devin Galtner
Payment collection varies by service type (covered vs. ad-hoc) Devin Galtner		

Creative Collaboration

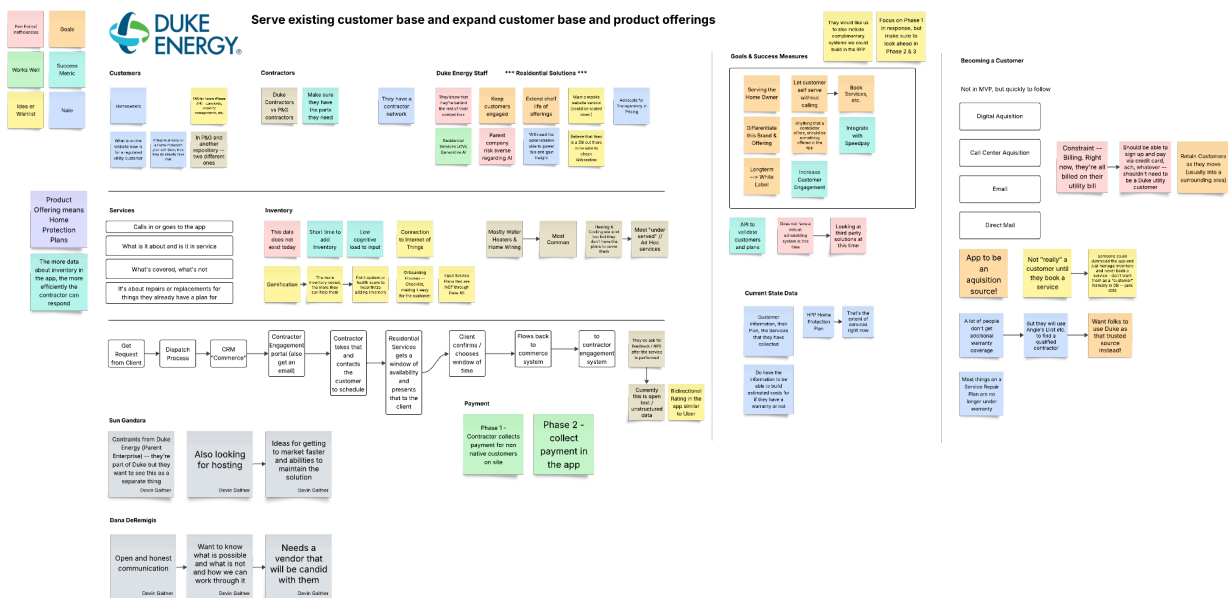
Orases provides unique value to our partners through our culture of creative collaboration. We leverage our partners' learning styles, a suite of virtual visualization tools, and creative professionals in order to learn, dream, design, and build solutions together with partners like Duke Energy Residential Services.

Below is the whiteboard from our initial 90 minute discovery session. We lean in to visuals to ensure team alignment through virtual white boards, prototypes, process flows, and other interactive, visual discussion aids.

Clickable Solutionion Prototype

You can find our clickable prototype for the Duke Energy Residential Services mobile app at the following URL. We recommend navigating to this URL on your mobile device so that you can truly see how it would look and feel for customers using the app on their phone.

<https://duke-energy-home-guardian.orases.app/>



Section I - Supplementary Information and Questionnaires

In addition to the items listed above, please be sure to complete the following supplementary items:

3.1 Master Service Agreement Review

Please review the Master Consulting Service Agreement and provide any redlines of terms for which your firm cannot agree. If your company has an existing Master Consulting Services Agreement with Duke Energy, you may upload the executed document. Please be advised that any MCSA not executed or updated within the last 1-2 years will likely require an amendment.

Submitted

3.2 Wood Mackenzie Data Questionnaires

Complete questionnaires on the Commercial tab of the Bid Event. The fields in the questionnaires enable the review of summary information for each Bidder. Any in-depth or supporting information for these questions may be uploaded as separate attachment with corresponding document names. However, summarized responses to questions must still be entered within the questionnaire fields. Entering “see attached” or similar will not be considered a valid response.

Submitted

3.3 Financial Statement

4.9.1 Audited financial statements are required for evaluation of financial stability and capability of the Respondent. Submit financial statements with your RFP Package in accordance with the timeline mentioned.

Submitted

4.9.2 Duke Energy reserves the right to obtain further credit references from other sources such as, but not limited to, Dun & Bradstreet, Better Business Bureau, and the Respondent's bank.

Understood

4.9.3 All financial statements and other financial or credit information obtained will be held in strict confidence and will only be used for the purpose of evaluating the Respondent for purposes of this RFP. Financial or credit information will not be released to any third party except as required by law.

Understood

3.4. Third Party Risk Management Services Profile Summary

Respond to the questions asked within the Third-Party Risk Management Services Profile Summary with complete answers. A more robust questionnaire may be required at a later date.

Submitted